Scheduled Tasks

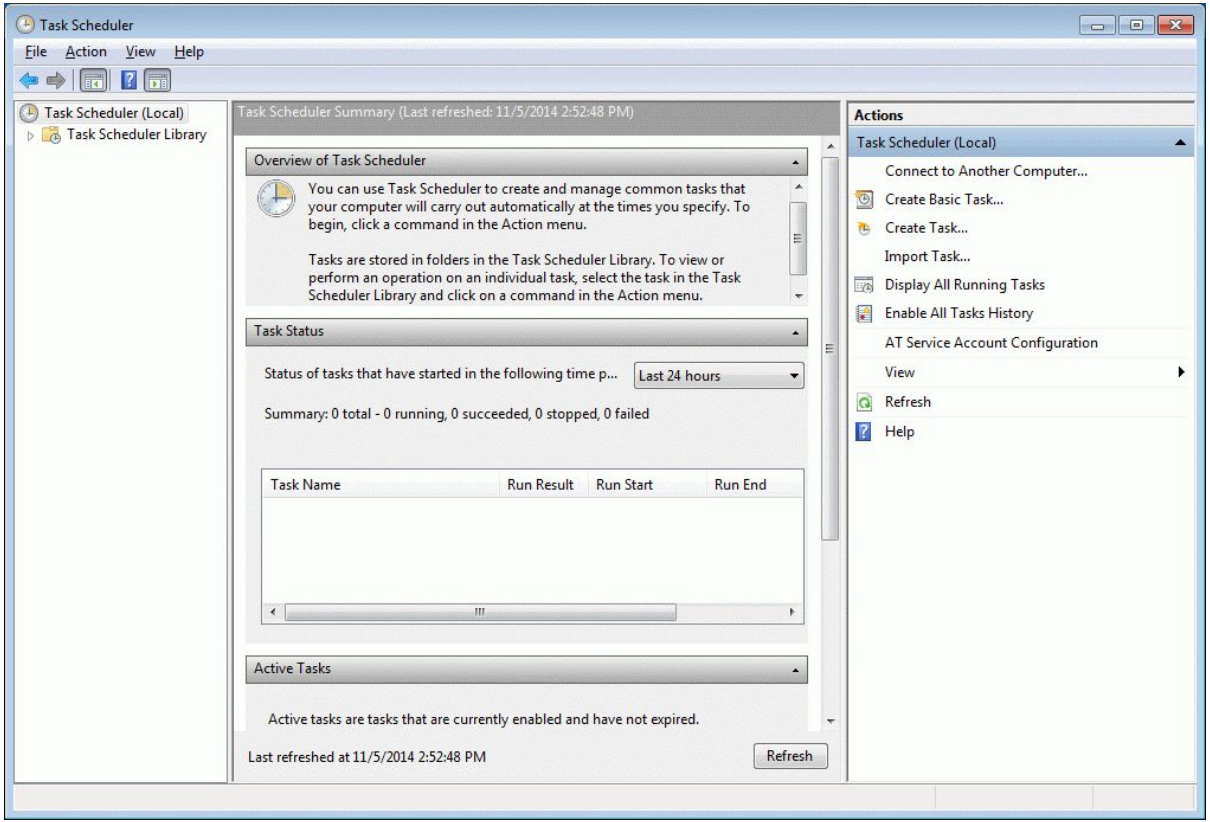
another powerpoint

So basically...

- What are scheduled tasks?
  - Run tasks at specific schedules
  - Upon an event
  - After x amount of time
- Why are we learning about them?
  - Usually only for system maintenance
  - Hackers can take advantage of them

Task Scheduler

- Run “taskschd.msc” or simply search “task scheduler”
- Looks like this →



What does it do?

- “Task Status” Section does not work as it says it does so ignore it
- “Active Window” shows tasks that have been started before/ones that are waiting to be started
- You can create tasks on the right side through a helpful wizard
- On the right side it also allows you to “Show Hidden Tasks” under the “View” menu
    - Make sure this is checked

Finding Bad Tasks

What to do?

- First identify a bad task
  - This requires your “CyberPatriot deduction skills”
- “My recommendation is that you configure everything. When you restart your computer, look for any changes to your settings - if you find something, this MAY be indicative of a scheduled task ” ~Clement Chan
  - There could be other reasons why, but in these next examples we can assume that this is the case

Methods for searching

Manually

- Look at the attributes for each tasks
  - This includes name, trigger type, and action performed
- While this is a pain, this is the simplest method to do so

Other ways

- Sysinternals has Autoruns, a GUI that allows you to view all tasks in a better way
- If you prefer scripting, know that:
  - Tasks are stored in C:\System32\tasks
  - Tasks are XML files that run Task.Actions.Exec.Command